

BY DAY, MARRAKESH'S DJMA EL FNA is an enormous empty space close to the souks. As dusk falls it is magically transformed. Booths selling nuts and dried fruit open; squadrons of orange-juice stalls appear; a dozen or more barbecues roasting enormous quantities of meat are lit, sending plumes of smoke into the air; and entertainers of all kinds start to arrive. There are troupes of brightly clad but ragged child acrobats; storytellers; musicians; snake charmers; and belly-dancing female impersonators. Crowds amble around, eating and being entertained, while cars skim the perimeter of the square—giving the enchanted fairground the surreal air of a giant traffic island.

